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PLACEMENT READINESS · COMMUNICATION TRACK

Group Discussion & Professional Communication

Session 2 — Structuring confident, persuasive contributions in group discussions

Session Objectives

What You'll Walk Away With

01

Understand Group Discussions

Why recruiters use GDs to test teamwork and thinking under pressure, not just knowledge.

03

Master GD Etiquette

Speak with confidence without dominating, interrupting, or staying silent.

02

Learn the PREP Framework

A repeatable structure for turning any opinion into a clear, persuasive point.

04

Practice in a Live Discussion

Apply the framework in a real group activity, with peer feedback.

What Recruiters Look For

Beyond your opinion, these are the signals they're scoring



Communication

Can you explain your point clearly and concisely?



Critical Thinking

Do you reason with logic, or just repeat opinions?



Listening

Do you build on others, or just wait to speak?



Teamwork

Do you include others or dominate the floor?



Confidence

Do you speak up without being aggressive?

Types of Group Discussion Topics

1

Factual / Topic-based

A known subject you can reason about directly.

“Should college attendance be made optional?”

2

Case-study based

A short situation with a problem to solve as a group.

“Your team's project is 2 days behind. What now?”

3

Abstract topic

A phrase with no fixed meaning — tests creative reasoning.

“When the going gets tough, the tough get going.”

THE FRAMEWORK

The PREP Framework

One structure for every point you make in a group discussion

P

Point

R

Reason

E

Example

P

Point Again



Point

How to use it

State your opinion in one clear sentence

- Say it directly — no long wind-up before you get there
- This is what the group will remember, so make it unambiguous

EXAMPLE

Part 1 of 4 — PREP Framework

“I believe mobile phones should be allowed in classrooms.”



Reason

How to use it

Explain WHY you hold that opinion

- One strong reason beats three weak ones
- This is where the group checks if you can actually think, not just state

EXAMPLE

Part 2 of 4 — PREP Framework

“Because they let students quickly look up information during class.”



Example

How to use it

Back your reason with a real example or data

- Use a fact, a personal instance, or a well-known case
- This should be the most concrete, specific part of your turn

EXAMPLE

Part 3 of 4 — PREP Framework

“In our lab sessions, quick access to documentation cut our debugging time in half.”



Point Again

How to use it

Restate your point to close the loop

- Keep it short — one sentence is enough
- A restated point signals you're done and ready to yield the floor

EXAMPLE

Part 4 of 4 — PREP Framework

“So overall, phones in class do more good than harm.”

Worked Example — Full Turn

TOPIC: SHOULD SOCIAL MEDIA HAVE AN AGE LIMIT?

P

Point

I believe social media platforms should enforce a stricter minimum age limit.

R

Reason

Because younger users are especially vulnerable to comparison and cyberbullying.

E

Example

Several countries are already piloting age-verification laws for this exact reason.

P

Point Again

So a stricter age limit would protect the users who need it most.

The GD Evaluation Rubric

01

Initiation

Opening the discussion, or entering it at the right moment.

02

Arguments

Logical, relevant points — not just opinions repeated louder.

03

Listening

Responding to what others said, not talking in isolation.

04

Turn Management

Speaking up without interrupting or cutting others off.

05

Fluency

Clear, steady delivery without excess fillers or hesitation.

06

Summary

Closing the discussion by pulling the group's points together.

Useful Phrases for a GD

To Enter / Initiate

"I'd like to start by saying..."

"May I add a point here?"

To Agree / Add

"I agree with that, and I'd add..."

"Building on what you said..."

To Disagree Politely

"I see it differently, because..."

"I respectfully disagree, since..."

To Interrupt Politely

"Sorry, may I come in here?"

"Just to add a quick point..."

To Summarize / Close

"To sum up what we discussed..."

"Overall, the group leans towards..."

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Small habits that quietly cost you marks in a GD



Interrupting others

Cutting someone off reads as aggressive, not confident.



Staying silent

A GD scores participation — silence is a guaranteed low score.



No examples or data

An opinion with nothing backing it is easy to dismiss.



Too many fillers (umm...)

Fillers make you sound unsure, even when your point is solid.

Class Activity

One discussion, whole class together — everyone gets a turn to speak

1

Prepare

3 minutes to silently note your opening point using PREP.

2

Discuss as One Group

The whole class discusses together, in front of the room.

3

Summarize

A volunteer closes each discussion before moving to the next topic.

TOPIC 1

Is AI a threat to jobs?

TOPIC 2

Are online classes better than offline classes?

Discuss FOR and AGAINST for each topic.

Homework

Write a 150-word opening statement using the PREP framework

TOPIC 1

Should attendance in college be made optional?

TOPIC 2

Should AI tools like ChatGPT be allowed for coding assignments?

Pick either topic. Due at the start of the next session.

P

R

E

P

Thank You

Questions?

Confident points, clearly made.